

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

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JOHN SPRINGER,

SUMMONS

Index No.:

Plaintiff,

-against-

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

CITY OF NEW YORK, EUGENE URMAN; PALOMA
PENA; FELIX TEJADA; JUSTIN TARAZA; AND JOHN
AND JANE DOE ONE THROUGH SIX,

Plaintiff designates BRONX
County as the place of trial.

Defendants.

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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
August 13, 2024

Yours, etc.



JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, ESQ

Attorney for Plaintiff

JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, ESQ PC

111 John Street, Suite 1850

New York, NY 10038

T: (212) 321-0025

F: (212) 321-0024

Defendants' Addresses:

CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel; 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007;

EUGENE URMAN; New York City Police Department, 47th Precinct, 4711 Laconia Avenue, Bronx, NY 10466;

PALOMA PENA; New York City Police Department, 47th Precinct, 4711 Laconia Avenue, Bronx, NY 10466;

FELIX TEJADA; New York City Police Department, 47th Precinct, 4711 Laconia Avenue, Bronx, NY 10466;

JUSTIN TARAZA; New York City Police Department, 47th Precinct, 4711 Laconia Avenue, Bronx, NY 10466;

JOHN AND JANE DOE ONE THROUGH SIX, 1 Police Plaza Path, New York, NY 10038.

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

----- X

JOHN SPRINGER,

INDEX NO.:

Plaintiff,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, EUGENE URMAN, PALOMA
PENA, FELIX TEJADA, JUSTIN TARAZA, AND
JOHN AND JANE DOE ONE THROUGH SIX
Defendants.

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

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Plaintiff JOHN SPRINGER by their attorney, John Paul DeVerna, as and for their Verified
Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York.
2. Plaintiff's claims arise out of a June 25, 2023, incident, in which defendants acting under color of state law unlawfully arrested, detained Plaintiff, and used excessive force upon Plaintiff. Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted until the matter ended in Plaintiff's favor.
3. As a result, Plaintiff suffered serious physical and emotional injuries.
4. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (compensatory and punitive) against Defendants, as well as an award of costs and attorneys' fees, and such other and further relief as the Court deems just and proper.

5. Plaintiff, in furtherance of their cause of action brought pursuant to New York State law, filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK, in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50, in accordance with controlling New York State law and jurisprudence.
6. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims or otherwise resolve them.
7. Plaintiff has complied with municipal defendant's request for an oral examination pursuant to Section 50-H of the New York General Municipal Law.
8. This action and all associated claims have been timely brought within the applicable statutes of limitations.
9. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.
10. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (compensatory and punitive) against Defendants, as well as an award of cost and attorneys' fees, and such other relief as the Court may deem just and proper.

PARTIES

11. Plaintiff JOHN SPRINGER is a resident of the State of New York.
12. The Defendant City of New York ("City") is a municipal corporation organized under the laws of the State of New York.
13. At all times relevant hereto, Defendant City, acting through the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the

appointment, training, supervision, discipline and retention and conduct of all NYPD personnel, agents, office holders, supervisors, as well as the individually named Defendants herein.

14. In addition, at all times here relevant, Defendant City was responsible for enforcing the rules of the NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws of the United States and the State of New York.
15. At all times relevant hereto, Defendant City, acting through the NYPD, was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, training, supervision, discipline and retention and conduct of all NYPD personnel, including police officers, detectives and supervisory officers as well as the individually named Defendants herein.
16. In addition, at all times here relevant, Defendant City was responsible for enforcing the rules of the NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws of the United States and the State of New York.
17. Defendant EUGENE URMAN was, at all times here relevant, a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant EUGENE URMAN was, at the time relevant herein, a police officer in the 47th Precinct. Defendant EUGENE URMAN is sued in their individual and official capacities.
18. Defendant PALOMA PENA was, at all times here relevant, a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant PALOMA PENA was, at the time relevant herein, a

lieutenant in the 47th Precinct. Defendant PALOMA PENA is sued in their individual and official capacities.

19. Defendant FELIX TEJADA was, at all times here relevant, a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant FELIX TEJADA was, at the time relevant herein, a police officer in the 47th Precinct. Defendant FELIX TEJADA is sued in their individual and official capacities.
20. Defendant JUSTIN TARAHA was, at all times here relevant, a police officer employed by the NYPD and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant and employee of the City of New York. Defendant JUSTIN TARAHA was, at the time relevant herein, a police officer in the 47th Precinct. Defendant JUSTIN TARAHA is sued in their individual and official capacities.
21. At all times relevant Defendants John and Jane Doe One Through Six were police officers, detectives, undercover police officers, supervisors, policy makers and/or officials employed by the NYPD. At this time, Plaintiff does not know the real names and/or shield number of Defendants John and Jane Doe One Through Six, but such information is believed to be in the possession of Defendants.
22. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of State law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and

employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

FACTUAL CHARGES

23. On or about June 25, 2023, at approximately 09:54 AM, Plaintiff was in the vicinity of 4111 Laconia Avenue, Bronx, New York 10466.
24. On or about that date and time, Defendants, including Defendants EUGENE URMAN, PALOMA PENA, FELIX TEJADA, JUSTIN TARAZA, and JOHN AND JANE DOE ONE THROUGH SIX, while acting in concert, falsely arrested and detained Plaintiff.
25. Plaintiff was not told what they were being arrested for.
26. Plaintiff did not resist a lawful arrest and complied with all lawful orders.
27. Based on information and belief, a Defendant supervisor was present on the scene and did not stop the unlawful arrest of Plaintiff.
28. At the time of Plaintiff's arrest, Defendants officers did not have probable cause or reasonable suspicion to believe Plaintiff had committed any criminal offense or violation of the law. Further, given the information available, Defendants knew or should have known Plaintiff was innocent of any wrongdoing or should have further inquired into the matter prior to making any arrest.
29. After Plaintiff's arrest, at the Precinct, Plaintiff was subjected to a search of the intimate parts of their body causing embarrassment and humiliation.
30. Plaintiff was falsely charged with assorted crimes under arrest number B23627229.
31. Plaintiff was unlawfully detained for approximately sixteen (16) hours before being released.

32. Defendants prepared false sworn affidavits and false police reports relating to Plaintiff's arrest.
33. The Defendant police officers falsely stated to the Bronx County District Attorney's Office that Plaintiff had committed a crime despite knowing that they lacked a legal and factual basis to allege that Plaintiff committed any crime.
34. Based on the information provided to them, the Bronx County District Attorney's Office charged Plaintiff with several charges under docket number CR-013856-23BX, all of which were later dismissed.
35. On or about June 25, 2023, at approximately 09:30 AM, Plaintiff was in the vicinity of 4111 Laconia Ave., Bronx, New York 10466 to pick up his daughter at the designated drop-off pick up area. When Plaintiff asked for a Domestic Incident Report to be filed when his daughter was not dropped off, Defendants officers, instead assaulted Plaintiff, pushing him down the stairs causing him injuries, including to his head, back, and ankle and threatening him with arrest. Outside of the precinct, Plaintiff called 911 and an ambulance responded.
36. On or about June 25, 2023, at approximately 09:54 AM, Plaintiff, who was speaking with the responding EMT's was in front of 4111 Laconia Ave., Bronx, New York 10466 and thereafter, Defendant Officers, including Defendants EUGENE URMAN, PALOMA PENA, FELIX TEJADA, JUSTIN TARAHA, and JOHN AND JANE DOE ONE THROUGH SIX, while acting in concert, without adequate cause and in contravention of NYPD policies and procedures and the law more generally, assaulted Plaintiff.
37. During the assault, Defendants EUGENE URMAN, PALOMA PENA, FELIX TEJADA, JUSTIN TARAHA, and JOHN AND JANE DOE ONE THROUGH SIX, while acting in

concert, and each aiding the other, approached Plaintiff and after speaking discourteously and harassing him, perpetrated multiple assault and batteries upon him, grabbing his limbs and body, pushing and striking him, pointing tasers at him, grabbed and twisted his arms, put knees upon his back, putting handcuffs on him excessively tight, lifted him from his arms, all without adequate cause and in contravention of NYPD Policy, causing claimant pain, injury and to fear for his personal safety.

38. Defendants' actions did cause Plaintiff to become fearful for his life and safety and did cause emotional and physical injuries to Plaintiff, the extent of which is unknown but include pain in the neck, lower back, the right ankle, shoulders, the right hip, and both wrists, as well as head swelling and compressions in the back.
39. Some of the Defendant officers, as well as the Defendant City, knew or should have had reason to know of the assaulting officers' temperament and propensity for violence yet failed to appreciate the risk posed to the public and further failed to take adequate precautions to prevent the conduct as described herein
40. Defendants were knowingly and deliberately indifferent to the possibility that its police officers, were wont to violate the constitutional rights of arrestees as described herein.
41. Defendant Officers placed Plaintiff in unreasonably tight handcuffs, which Plaintiff complained about, and which did cause severe injuries to Plaintiff's wrists.
42. The force used by Defendants caused Plaintiff personal, physical, and emotional injuries for which he later sought medical treatment.
43. Defendants repeatedly falsified information relating to the facts and circumstances surrounding Plaintiff's arrest.

44. During all of the events described, Defendants acted maliciously, willfully, knowingly and with the specific intent to injure Plaintiff and violate their civil rights.
45. Some of the Defendant officers who did not participate in the incident but were otherwise present and observed the violation of Plaintiff's constitutional rights failed to intercede on Plaintiff's behalf.
46. Plaintiff's injury was a foreseeable result of Defendant officers unlawful conduct and was the proximate cause of their injuries.
47. The City has been on notice that Defendants EUGENE URMAN, PALOMA PENA, FELIX TEJADA, JUSTIN TARAHA and JOHN AND JANE DOE ONE THROUGH SIX, had a history and practice of misconduct against individuals but failed to take appropriate corrective action. Indeed, A review of their CCRB and Civil lawsuit history¹ shows the following: EUGENE URMAN has 9 CCRB complaints, on 4 separate dates, as well as being a named officer in several lawsuits alleging police misconduct including, Bronx County 28292/2020E, Bronx County 31212/2018E, Bronx County 810323/2022E, Bronx County 812930/2023E, Bronx County 815397/2022E and whose NYPD Internal Misconduct Records show they were Guilty of failing to notify a supervisor and failing to make activity log entry; PALOMA PENA (4 CCRB complaints), as well as being a named officer in a lawsuit involving alleged police misconduct, Bronx County 21739/2015E; FELIX TEJADA has 3 CCRB complaints, on 2 separate dates; and JUSTIN TARAHA has 4 CCRB complaints on 3 separate dates.

¹ The cited information was procured from Law Enforcement Lookup (LELU) "an extension of the Legal Aid Society's Cop Accountability Project (CAP), which empowers organizations and communities across New York City to hold police officers accountable for civil rights violations" See <https://legalaidnyc.org/law-enforcement-look-up/>

48. The City has been on notice for more than a generation that brutality is widespread and that particular reforms need to be implemented. From reform-minded Commissioner Patrick Murphy to the *Mollen* Commission twenty-five years later, the City has been repeatedly cautioned that a systemic tolerance for brutality flourishes throughout the NYPD. Indeed, years before said violation was perpetrated upon Plaintiff, the *Mollen* Commission report noted, “This tolerance, or willful blindness, extends to supervisors as well.
49. Plaintiff asserts that the Defendants who violated Plaintiff's civil rights, are part of a larger pattern and practice of similar conduct, which is so widespread, pervasive and consistent throughout the NYPD, and the City of New York that the commission of such constitutionally violent behavior has become tantamount to an official policy or custom within the NYPD, and the City of New York or, at the very least, conclusive evidence that the City, NYPD have either tacitly approved of such egregious wrongdoings or that they have become deliberately indifferent to the Civil Rights of those who may come into contact with police officers.
50. The individually named Defendants herein, as well as other officers serving in the employee of the NYPD, and the City of New York, have blatantly, shamelessly, consistently, and repeatedly engaged in conduct violative of the civil rights guaranteed and protected by the Constitution of the United States, in addition to the laws and Constitution of the State of New York, or without incurring any ramifications for such misconduct and, ostensibly, with the full and complete blessing of the NYPD, The City of New York and their respective policymakers and supervisors.
51. *The New York Times*, as well as numerous other reputable journalistic enterprises, have reported on the widespread corruption with the NYPD, and City of New York, particularly

the incredibly disconcerting proclivity of many NYPD officers to engage in the fabrication or misrepresentation or subject matters that are materially relevant to criminal prosecutions, including the complete fabrication of arrest evidence and witnesses. Also detailed, is the NYPD obstinate refusal to effectuate corrective or preventive measures to combat the inevitable recurrence of such misdeeds, and perhaps most troubling, the NYPD's alarming tendency to, instead reward and promote these officers including those who are implicated via some incontrovertible form of evidence.

52. On March 18, 2018, *The New York Times* published an explosive article entitled *Promotions, Not Punishments For Officers Accused of Lying*, written by Joseph Goldstein. Mr. Goldstein shines the light on the multitude of flaws within the CCRB and the NYPD, highlighting the fact that the substantiation of a claim against an officer will invariably rely on the presence of incontrovertible proof against the officer. Due to the rarity of this type of evidence, in alarmingly small percentage of officers' misconduct claims are substantiated. The CCRB is further handicapped by a terribly designed system that requires evidence of a virtually indisputable nature to substantiate any claim against an officer. The article also details the NYPD's reluctance to investigate or discipline officers who lie and posits that this reluctance is a significant cause of the lying pandemic within the NYPD. The article references various officers and detectives who were the subject of credible accusations relating to the officers intentionally false statements, with some allegations coming from federal and state judges.
53. The NYPD has a long-standing and ignominious record of failing to discipline its officers or even entertaining allegations of wrongdoing against them. On June 26, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article entitled *2495 Reports of Police Bias*. One was deemed

valid by the NYPD worried that within the last five years almost 2,500 several individuals have filed formal complaint with the NYPD alleging that an officer acted with biased towards them, would not one single being substantiated by the NYPD such a finding is playing the incredible and obviously the result of a deliberately poor or non-existent investigatory protocol the report commitment to combat the prejudices and the bias is exhibited by many of their officers.

54. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers, officials or supervisors have approved or acquiesced to policies, customs, or patterns and practices within the NYPD that resulted in Plaintiff's arrest without probable cause
55. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the city of New York, and their respective policymakers or supervisors have failed to provide adequate training regarding the identification of probable cause, reason suspicion or the appropriate amount of force to be used.
56. Defendant's actions, pursuant to plaintiff's underlying arrest, which occurred without even the semblance of probable cause, were so blatantly violative of plaintiff's civil rights that the tacit approval by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD, and the City of New York, as well as their deliberate indifference towards the right of any individuals who may come into contact with dependents, should be inferred, because such makers deprivations of constitutionally protected rights could not and would not occur without the tacit approval or deliberate indifference regarding the commission of such violations by the policymakers were supervisors of the NYPD, and City of New York.

57. Upon information and belief further details and facts relating to the unlawful policies customs or patterns and practices of the NYPD, the City of New York and their respective policymakers supervisors police officers or employees, will become known after the completion of Discovery, as such information is presently within the exclusive possession of defendants, the NYPD, and the City of New York
58. Upon information and belief, the personal files, records and disciplinary histories of the officers Defendants will reveal a history of constitutional violations indicative of Defendant City's, knowledge that the individual officer Defendants were unfit for employment as NYPD officers, or poor employment in general, and that the probability of the individually named defendant committed similar violations in the future was extremely high.
59. Upon information and belief said personnel files records and disciplinary histories will conclusively show that the city, and the NYPD were fully aware Defendant passed constitutional violations, unacceptably high probability for the reoccurrence of similar transgressions, the unreasonably dangerous situations that were likely to result from their hiring or retention, as well as their unsuitability for employment as Law Enforcement Officers, or for employment in general, and not the NYPD, and the City of New York to engage in any preventative or corrective action in the likelihood of recurrence for such violations, which is tantamount to the city of tacit approval of such misconduct or the city's deliberate indifference towards civil rights of those who may interact with employees including Plaintiff
60. As a direct and proximate result of the acts of Defendants, Plaintiff suffered the following injuries and damages: violation of their rights pursuant to the Fourth and Fourteenth

Amendments of the United States Constitution, physical injury, physical pain and suffering, emotional trauma and suffering, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, emotional distress, frustration, extreme inconvenience, anxiety, loss of liberty and harm to reputation.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop and Search
Under New York State Law

61. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
62. Defendants violated Common Law, the Laws of the State of New York and the New York Constitution because they stopped Plaintiff without reasonable suspicion.
63. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
64. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.
65. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Stop and Search
Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

66. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
67. The individually named police officer Defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be unlawfully stopped and searched, and subjected to denial of their due process rights and denied the right to a fair trial without probable cause in violation of plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable stop and seizure and denial of due process under the Fourth and Fifth and Amendment of the Constitution

of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

68. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
69. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
70. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered mental injuries, economic injury, deprivation of property, liberty and privacy, terror, humiliation, damage to reputation and other psychological injuries. All of said injuries may be permanent.
71. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment
Under New York State Law

72. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
73. Defendants subjected Plaintiff to false arrest, false imprisonment, and deprivation of liberty without probable cause.
74. Plaintiff was conscious of their confinement.
75. Plaintiff did not consent to their confinement.
76. Plaintiff's arrest and false imprisonment was not otherwise privileged.
77. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

78. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.
79. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment
Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

80. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
81. The Defendants violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the U.S.
82. Constitution by wrongfully and illegally arresting, detaining and imprisoning Plaintiff.
83. The wrongful, unjustifiable, and unlawful apprehension, arrest, detention, and imprisonment of Plaintiff was carried out without a valid warrant, without Plaintiff's consent, and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion.
84. At all relevant times, Defendants acted forcibly in apprehending, arresting, and imprisoning Plaintiff.
85. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
86. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.
87. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

Under New York State Law

88. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
89. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct and failed to intervene.
90. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
91. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

92. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
93. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct and failed to intervene.
94. Accordingly, the Defendants who failed to intervene violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments.
95. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Abuse of Process

Under New York State Law

96. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

97. Dependents arrested, detained and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated against Plaintiff to compel the compliance or forbearance of some act.
98. Defendants had no excuse or justification to forcibly detain or initiate a prosecution against Plaintiff, especially with the absence of any cognizable probable cause.
99. Defendant intended to inflict substantial harm upon Plaintiff.
100. Defendant acted to achieve a collateral purpose, beyond or in addition to Plaintiff's criminal prosecution.
101. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
102. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Abuse of Process

Under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

103. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
104. Dependents arrested, detained and caused a criminal prosecution to be initiated against Plaintiff to compel the compliance or forbearance of some act.
105. Defendants had no excuse or justification to forcibly detain or initiate a prosecution against Plaintiff, especially with the absence of any cognizable probable cause.
106. Defendant intended to inflict substantial harm upon Plaintiff.
107. Defendant acted to achieve a collateral purpose, beyond or in addition to Plaintiff's criminal prosecution.
108. Defendant's actions deprived plaintiff of their constitutional rights, under the Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

109. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution Under
New York State Law

110. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
111. By their conduct, as described herein, Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for the violation of their constitutional right to be free from malicious prosecution under Common Law, the Laws of the State of New York and the New York Constitution.
112. Defendants, acting with malice, initiated a prosecution against Plaintiff and caused them to be prosecuted.
113. The prosecution by Defendants of Plaintiff constituted malicious prosecution in that there was no basis for Plaintiff's arrest, yet Defendants continued with the prosecution, which was resolved in Plaintiff's favor.
114. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.
115. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.
116. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution
Under 42 U.S.C. §1983 Against Individual Defendants

117. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

118. By their conduct, as described herein, Defendants are liable to Plaintiff for the violation of their constitutional right to be free from malicious prosecution under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.
119. Defendants, acting with malice, initiated a prosecution against Plaintiff and caused them to be prosecuted.
120. The prosecution by Defendants of Plaintiff constituted malicious prosecution in that there was no basis for Plaintiff's arrest, yet Defendants continued with the prosecution, which was resolved in Plaintiff's favor.
121. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of respondeat superior.
122. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.
123. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION (PUSHED DOWN STAIRS)

Assault and Battery Under
New York State Law

124. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
125. Defendants made plaintiff fear for their physical well-being and safety and placed plaintiff in apprehension of immediate harmful and/or offensive touching.
126. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful and/or offensive touching and battered them without his consent.

127. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
128. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries, as well as to suffer serious, severe, permanent personal injuries and extreme conscious physical, mental and emotional pain and suffering, and required, and will require, hospitalization, medical care and treatment all of which are believed will for a long time to come.
129. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION (PUSHED DOWN STAIRS)

Excessive Force Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983

130. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
131. Defendants violated the Fourth, Eighth, and Fourteenth Amendments because they used unreasonable force on the plaintiff without consent.
132. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault and Battery Under
New York State Law

133. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
134. Defendants made plaintiff fear for their physical well-being and safety and placed plaintiff in apprehension of immediate harmful and/or offensive touching.
135. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful and/or offensive touching and battered them without his consent.

136. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

137. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries, as well as to suffer serious, severe, permanent personal injuries and extreme conscious physical, mental and emotional pain and suffering, and required, and will require, hospitalization, medical care and treatment all of which are believed will for a long time to come.

By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Excessive Force Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983

138. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

139. Defendants violated the Fourth, Eighth, and Fourteenth Amendments because they used unreasonable force on the plaintiff without consent.

140. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Intentional Infliction of Emotional Distress
Under New York State Law

141. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

142. When unlawfully arresting Plaintiff, Defendants assaulted and used excessive force against Plaintiff, intentionally and for the purpose of causing severe emotional distress recklessly conducted themselves towards plaintiff in a manner so shocking and outrageous that it

exceeded all reasonable bounds of decency resulting in causing plaintiff severe emotional distress.

143. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.
144. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
145. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered mental injuries, economic injury, deprivation of property, liberty and privacy, terror, humiliation, damage to reputation and other psychological injuries. All of said injuries may be permanent.
146. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Municipal "Monell" Liability
42 U.S.C. § 1983 Against Individual Defendants

147. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
148. Defendants, collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law, acquiesced in a pattern of unconstitutional conduct by subordinate police officers, and were directly responsible for the violation of the plaintiff's constitutional rights.
149. Defendant City maintained a policy or custom that caused Plaintiff to be deprived of their civil rights, tacitly approved of such violent conduct or was deliberately indifferent toward the potential exposure of individuals, such as Plaintiff, to such violent behavior.

150. Defendant City's employee police officers have engaged in an illegal pattern and practice of misconduct, so consistent and widespread that it constitutes a custom or usage, of which a supervisor or policymaker must have been aware of them.
151. Defendant City, its' policymakers and supervisors fail to provide adequate training or supervision to their subordinates, to such an extent that it is tantamount to the City's deliberate indifference towards the rights of those who may come into contact with defendant City's employees.
152. Defendant City's employees engaged in such egregious and flagrant violations of Plaintiff's constitutional right that the need for enhanced training or supervision is obvious and equates to a display of indifference towards the rights of individuals, who may come into contact with infinite City's employees.
153. Defendant City's repeated refusal or failure to install or apply corrective or preventive measures constitutes the tacit approval of such violent behaviors or a deliberate indifference to the rights of those who may be affected by such behavior.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention and Supervision
Under New York State Law

154. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
155. Defendant City owed a duty of care to Plaintiff to adequately hire, retain and supervise its employee defendants.
156. Defendant City breached that duty of care.
157. Defendant City placed defendants in a position where they could inflict foreseeable harm.

158. Defendant City knew or should have known of its employee defendants' propensity for violating the individual rights granted under the United States Constitution and the laws of the State of New York, prior to the injuries incurred by Plaintiff.
159. Defendant City failed to take reasonable measures in hiring, retaining and supervising its employee defendants that would have prevented the aforesaid injuries to Plaintiff.
160. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.
161. By reason of the above, the amount of damages sought on this cause of action exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction.
162. Defendant City's conduct cause the violation of Plaintiff civil rights enumerated within the Constitution of the United States pursuant to the Fourth, Sixth, and Fourteenth and under rights including:
- a) Not to be deprived of liberty without due process of law;
 - b) To be free from seizure and arrest not based upon probable cause;
 - c) Not to have summary punishment imposed upon them; and
 - d) To receive equal protection under the law.
163. As a direct and proximate result of this conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION CAUSE OF ACTION

Individual Defendant Officer's Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

164. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
165. Defendant Officers' acts constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom, or usage.

166. Defendant Officers' acts caused Plaintiff to be deprived of their rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in their person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.
167. Defendant Officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized, assaulted, frisked, and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing their detention.
168. As a direct and proximate result of this conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Individual Defendant Officer's Failure to Intervene
in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights

169. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
170. Defendant Officers' acts constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom, or usage.
171. Defendant Officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of their rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in their person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.
172. Defendant officers that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8-802 right against unreasonable search and seizure and excessive force had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

173. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of their rights.
174. As a direct and proximate result of this conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Article I, § 12 of the New York State Constitution

175. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.
176. Such conduct breached the protections guaranteed to plaintiff by the New York State Constitution, including but not limited to, Article 1, §§ 1, 6, 8, 9, 11, and 12, and including the following rights:
- I. freedom from unreasonable search and seizure of their person and property;
 - II. freedom from arrest without probable cause;
 - III. freedom from false imprisonment, that being wrongfully detained without good faith, reasonable suspicion, or legal justification, and of which wrongful detention plaintiff was aware and did not consent;
 - IV. freedom from the lodging of false charges against them by police officers and prosecutors, including on information and belief, by some or all of the individual defendants; and
 - V. freedom from deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

177. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered mental injuries, economic injury, deprivation of property, liberty and privacy, terror, humiliation, damage to reputation and other psychological injuries. All of said injuries may be permanent.

JURY DEMAND

178. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests judgment against Defendants, jointly and severally:

- a) For each and every of the previously stated Causes of Action, a sum of money having a present value which exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter; and
- b) Awarding Plaintiff reasonable attorneys' fees and costs pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988;
- c) Together with the costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law.

Dated: New York, New York
August 13, 2024



JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, ESQ
Attorney for Plaintiff
JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, ESQ PC
111 John Street, Suite 1850
New York, NY 10038
T: (212) 321-0025
F: (212) 321-0024

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a counsel of the law firm of **JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, ESQ PC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because plaintiff does not reside in the county where I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
August 6, 2024



JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, ESQ
Attorney for Plaintiff
JOHN PAUL DEVERNA, ESQ PC
111 John Street, Suite 1850
New York, NY 10038
T: (212) 321-0025
F: (212) 321-0024

Index No. :

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK

COUNTY OF BRONX

JOHN SPRINGER,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, EUGENE URMAN; PALOMA PENA; FELIX TEJADA;
JUSTIN TARAZA; AND JOHN AND JANE DOE ONE THROUGH SIX,

Defendants.

SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JOHN PAUL DEVERNA ESQ PC
By John Paul DeVerna, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff
111 John Street, Suite 1850
New York, New York 10038

To: CORPORATION COUNSEL OF NEW YORK
Attorney(s)for Defendants

Service of a copy of the within is hereby admitted.

Dated:

Attorney(s) for: